Specification of the controlled designation of origin "ROSÉ DES RICEYS"

approved by order of 31 July 2025, published in the JORF of 5 August 2025

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the provisions of the present specification may claim the controlled designation of origin "Rosé des Riceys", initially recognised by the decree of 8 December 1947.

II. – Geographical denominations, complementary terms

No specific provision.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Rosé des Riceys" is reserved for still rosé wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

a) The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following commune of the Aube department: Les Riceys.

b) The vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are also carried out within the territory of the following communes of the Aube department: Avirey-Lingey, Bagneux-la-Fosse, Balnot-sur-Laignes, Bragelogne-Beauvoir, Gyé-sur-Seine, Mussy-sur-Seine, Neuville-sur-Seine.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated in the commune of Les Riceys within the delimited parcel area of the controlled designation of origin "Champagne", with the exception of land which, by the nature of its soil or its situation, is unsuited to producing the wine of the appellation "Rosé des Riceys", as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 4 February 1949.

The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town hall of the commune of Les Riceys the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

V. – Grape varieties

The wines come exclusively from the pinot noir N variety.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) Planting density

General provisions:

The vines are planted with a spacing between rows that may not exceed 2.00 metres. The spacing between plants within the same row is between 0.70 metre and 1.50 metres.

The sum of the spacing between rows and the spacing between plants within the same row may not exceed 3.00 metres.

Any transformation of the parcel resulting in a change in planting density is prohibited until it is grubbed up.

Particular provisions:

In order to allow the passage of suitable machinery, parcels with either a slope greater than 35 %, or a slope greater than 25 % combined with a cross-slope greater than 10 %, may have alleys between 1.50 metres and 3 metres wide, at a maximum frequency of one row in six. In this case, the sum of the spacing between the other rows and the spacing between plants within the same row may not exceed 2.30 metres.

b) Pruning rules

A “free eye” means a bud separated from the base of the cane or “crown”, whatever the length of the internode.

Any overlapping between plants and any superposition of fruiting branches is prohibited.

The number of free eyes is less than or equal to 18 eyes per square metre.

Pruning is carried out at the latest before phenological stage (F) (Lorenz 12), i.e. four leaves unfolded.

The vines are pruned according to the following techniques:

CORDON (ROYAT) PRUNING	
Description	A single horizontal framework is established, without limitation of length, at a maximum height of 0.60 metre above ground level.
Particular requirements	a) The spurs are spaced at least 0.15 metre apart and are pruned to a maximum of 3 free eyes. b) The replacement spur known as the “rachet”, at the base of the cordon, is pruned to 2 free eyes. c) The extension is pruned to a maximum of 5 free eyes. d) Rejuvenation of the cordon may be carried out in one or more stages.
Particular provision	a) In the case of progressive rejuvenation by means of young wood, but without removal of the old framework, this young wood is trained along the old framework. Spurs requiring it are removed from the old framework so that there is no superposition or juxtaposition between the shoots of the two frameworks, and provided that it is not renewed each year on the same plant. b) The establishment of a framework in the opposite direction to that originally existing (known as a “retour”), intended to fill an accidental gap, is possible provided that it does not give rise to a launch of young wood renewed each year. c) The annual percentage of rejuvenation must not exceed 20 % of the plants of a single parcel.
SINGLE GUYOT AND DOUBLE GUYOT PRUNING	
Description	a) The vines are pruned: – by single Guyot pruning with one spur of a maximum of 3 free eyes and one cane of a maximum of 10 free eyes; – by double Guyot pruning with at most 2 spurs of a maximum of 2 free eyes and at most 2 canes of a maximum of 8 free eyes, of which a maximum of 6 are placed horizontally on the wire. b) The canes are tied at a maximum height of 0.60 metre above ground level.
Particular provision	a) In single Guyot, the canes may have 12 free eyes if they are arched. This cane must be tied on 2 wires 0.20 metre apart and the terminal bud must be tied at a height of 0.60 metre. b) In double Guyot, the canes may have a maximum of 10 free eyes if they are arched. This cane must be tied on 2 wires 0.20 metre apart and the terminal bud must be tied at a height of 0.60 metre.
ASYMMETRICAL GUYOT PRUNING	

CORDON (ROYAT) PRUNING	
Description	a) The vines are pruned: – with a rachet of a maximum of 2 free eyes; – a launch bearing a maximum of 6 free eyes; – an extension (fruiting) established at the end of the previous year's launch or of a framework more than 2 years old and bearing a maximum of 6 free eyes. b) The arrangement of the wood must be such that the last buds are at a maximum height of 0.60 metre.

c) Trellising rules

The trellising system is in place at the latest in the year of entry into production under the controlled designation of origin.

d) Tying

Tying is completed before phenological stage (I) (Lorenz 23), known as "flowering", and is consistent with the pruning system adopted.

e) Lifting

Lifting the shoots held by wires is compulsory. It is carried out at the latest at phenological stage (L) (Lorenz stage 33), known as "bunch closure".

f) Foliage height

The height of trellised foliage, after trimming, is at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows. It is measured between the tying wire and the upper trimming limit.

g) Average maximum load per parcel

The average maximum load per parcel is set at 19,700 kilograms of grapes per hectare.

The number of bunches per square metre of vine in production is less than or equal to 17.

h) Threshold of missing vines

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 20 %.

i) Cultivation condition of the vine

The parcels must be managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

In order to preserve the characteristics of the soils, which constitute a fundamental element of the terroir:

a) Permanent grass cover of the headlands is compulsory;

b) The use of composts and organic household waste, and of sewage sludge other than that from wine-making installations, alone or mixed, is prohibited;

c) The maximum width of the strip that may be chemically weeded is 40 centimetres on either side of the vine row;

d) The inter-row must have a plant cover, spontaneous or sown, from 30 November to 31 January of the following year;

e) Vine plantings and replacements are carried out with plants all of whose components (scions and rootstocks) have been hot-water treated before grafting. Failing this, the plants are hot-water treated

before planting. Hot-water treatment must be carried out in a station approved by FranceAgriMer;

f) Any substantial modification of the morphology of the subsoil or of the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin is prohibited, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) The wines come from grapes harvested at good ripeness.

The date of the start of the harvest is set in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-6 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

A date for the end of picking is set by prefectoral order on the proposal of the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality, after consulting the defence and management body.

b) Particular harvesting provisions

Any means that does not allow whole bunches of grapes to be harvested is prohibited.

c) Particular provisions for transport of the harvest

The grapes are transported whole to the vinification installations.

The baskets, boxes and crates used to transport the grapes from the place of picking to the vinification installation have holes in the bottom and on all sides allowing rapid and complete drainage of the juice while awaiting vinification.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) Sugar content of the grapes

Grapes with a sugar content of less than 170 grams per litre of must may not be considered to be at good ripeness.

b) Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume

The wines have a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 10 %.

c) Repealed.

VIII. – Yields – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 12,400 kilograms of grapes per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 15,500 kilograms of grapes per hectare.

3° – Entry into production of the vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may only be granted to wines coming from parcels of young vines from the second year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July.

4° – Particular provisions

a) The wines are obtained within the limit of a volume of 102 litres of settled must per 160 kilograms of grapes used. For a given harvest, and taking particular account of its characteristics, an inter-ministerial order may reduce this volume.

b) Press wines obtained at the end of pressing beyond the maximum authorised volume are treated as "rebêches".

c) The wines are taken into account for the controlled designation of origin, at the latest when the harvest declaration is made, at the rate of 98.5 % of their volume.

d) The rate of rebêches is a minimum extraction of between 0 % and 10 % of the quantity of settled musts eligible for the controlled designation of origin. These rebêches are sent to a distillery before 15 December of the year following that of the harvest.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

1° – General provisions

a) Reception and pressing

Weighing of the grapes is compulsory at the place of pressing and vatting.

The wines are vinified as whole bunches (non-destemmed grapes) with semi-carbonic maceration.

b) Analytical standards

The wines have a fermentable sugar content (glucose and fructose) less than or equal to 3 grams per litre.

c) Oenological practices and physical treatments

The use of oenological charcoal, alone or mixed in preparations, is prohibited.

The use of pieces of wood is prohibited.

After enrichment, the wines do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13 %.

The increase in the volume of fermenting must used may not exceed 1.12 % for each 1 % increase in the alcoholic strength by volume during the enrichment operation.

Excess volumes are destroyed by being sent for industrial uses before 15 December of the year following that of the harvest, in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-14 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

d) Upkeep of the cellar and equipment

The cellar (floor and walls) and the vinification equipment are in a good general state of upkeep.

2° – Provisions by type of product

a) The wines are aged at least until 1 July of the year following that of the harvest.

b) The elaboration of the wines entails the elimination, before 31 July of the year following that of the harvest, of the by-products of vinification at the rate of 1.5 % of the settled musts.

3° – Provisions relating to packaging

a) The wines are packaged in new bottles.

b) For every packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body:

– the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code;

– an analysis carried out before or after packaging.

The analysis reports are kept for a period of sixty months from the date of packaging.

4° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator provides evidence of a specific place for the storage of packaged products.

5° – Provisions relating to the circulation of products and placing on the market for the consumer

At the end of the ageing period, the wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 15 July of the year following that of the harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area extends over eight communes in the south of the Aube department. However, the harvesting of the grapes is limited to the commune of Les Riceys and reserved for precisely delimited parcels.

The landscape of Les Riceys forms part of the geological sequence of the Côte des Bar. The Kimmeridgian stage (Upper Jurassic or Malm) makes up most of the geological substratum, deeply incised at its centre by the valley of the Laignes and numerous peripheral small valleys. The summits of the hillsides, most often wooded, extend into a plateau made up of hard Portlandian limestones.

The Kimmeridgian, characterised by alternating marls and limestone beds, gives rise to the best soils of the vineyard, made up of grey clay-limestone colluvium that has covered the slopes, incorporating a multitude of small stones that contribute to warming the soil. The wines come from the single variety pinot noir N harvested on the steepest, highest and sunniest slopes, facing east and south.

The northern location and the proximity of the Langres plateau produce a fairly cold climate, but the circular configuration of the vineyard, set within the small valleys, helps to give it a genuine, very favourable mesoclimate. Indeed, it is not unusual to record stifling temperatures above 40 °C in these hollows in summer.

b) Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Although certainly present from Antiquity, the attested origin of the Les Riceys vineyard goes back to the 8th century, with documents recording the existence of vines on the territory of the commune; it is thought to have been established by the lords of Tonnerre, vassals of the Duke of Burgundy.

In the 12th century, the Cistercians of the abbey of Molesme, liegemen of the Count of Champagne, created the Saint-Louis estate at Les Riceys.

From the beginning of the 18th century, the wines of Les Riceys gave rise to a significant trade with the Netherlands, Belgium, the Paris region and northern France, as shown by the dispatch statistics drawn up by the treaty offices of the province of Champagne. In 1875 the vineyard was prosperous. Many residences and vaulted cellars were built at that time. Nearly 35 merchants sold the wines of Les Riceys. This prosperity was weakened by the phylloxera crisis and by the rise of the textile industry in the Aube, which absorbed the rural workforce.

The vineyard was partly rebuilt thanks to the inclusion of the Aube in viticultural Champagne from 1927, but this reconstruction was difficult, marred by the world wars and disastrous climatic conditions until 1957. A few grower-producers remained, whose tenacity was rewarded by the

recognition of the controlled designation of origin “Rosé des Riceys” on 8 December 1947. Thanks to the arrival of many young wine-growers in the 1960s, a revival of viticultural activity relaunched production.

On 26 September 1968, the Syndicat de défense de l’AOC Rosé des Riceys was founded. It later became the Syndicat des producteurs de l’AOC Rosé des Riceys, today recognised as the defence and management body.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the product

Rosé des Riceys is a still wine that must bear a vintage.

Visually, its bright, intense robe ranges from light salmon to madder red. A fine and delicate wine, it has good persistence on the palate.

When young, the wine may show aromas of red fruit.

After several years of ageing, it develops a complex bouquet, frequently characterised by aromas of dried fruit and spices, and sometimes of candied fruit depending on the vintage.

In general, the wine is characterised by its finesse, its balance on the palate and its harmony.

3° – Causal interactions

The ripeness of the grapes is essential to the elaboration of “Rosé des Riceys”, so much so that in certain unfavourable years the wine-growers choose not to produce it: “it is only made in good years, so it always has great quality”, explained the French ampelographer V. Rendu in 1847.

The stony soils of the steepest slopes best exposed to the south and east allow, thanks to optimal light and good warming of the soil, an early start of vegetation in spring, optimise photosynthesis and guarantee the ripening of the berries.

The elevation of the wine-growing hillsides avoids contact with the cold air stagnating in the valley bottoms, and the mantle of forest covering the tops of the slopes and the many wooded islands scattered across the territory provide valuable protection against cold air masses coming from the plateaux.

The slope of the wine-growing hillsides ensures optimal natural drainage, also guaranteed by the fissuring of the Kimmeridgian limestones. The marls, interbedded between the limestone beds, provide the water reserve needed in summer, mainly in hot, dry years. Finally, the warm temperatures recorded in summer, coupled with the heat given off by the sun’s rays reflected off the Kimmeridgian stones, give the wine its characteristic notes of candied fruit and spices as it ages.

The character of the wine is essentially due to the skill of the winemaker who, choosing the best years, knows how to conduct the delicate stage of vinification.

The pinot noir N variety was already recognised in the 19th century by Jules Guyot as the best variety for making the wine of Les Riceys.

The harvest must be brought whole into the vat, in order best to respect the aromas of the pinot noir N variety and above all their development during vatting, whose duration is perfectly controlled by the know-how and experience of the winemaker.

V. Rendu noted that “at Les Riceys, the fine plants are reserved for the first cuvées. Long vattings are avoided in order to preserve in this wine the finesse and frankness of taste that characterise the wine of Les Riceys”.

The wine of Les Riceys was introduced to Versailles by labourers and stonemasons from Les Riceys – known as the “cnas doù solé” (the ducks of the sun). No doubt to give themselves heart for the work,

they broached a barrel of their Riceys wine. The “cnas” offered some to their lord, King Louis XIV, when he came to inquire about the progress of the works. From then on, Louis XIV became a fervent lover of Rosé des Riceys, which helped give the wine its prestige and renown. An original rosé, “this wine has only one fault: its rarity”, says the Larousse des vins.

XI. – Transitional measures

No specific provision.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

1° – General provisions

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin “Rosé des Riceys” is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

2° – Particular provisions

a) The wines must be presented with the indication of the vintage.

b) The labelling of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, provided that:

- it is the name of a registered cadastral lieu-dit;

- it appears on the harvest declaration.

The indication of a lieu-dit is only authorised if all the grapes used for the elaboration of the wines come from the lieu-dit concerned.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1° – Declaration of intention to produce

Every operator sends the defence and management body, at the latest fifteen days before the planned date of harvest, the list of parcels intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin.

2° – Declaration of adaptation of planting density under the particular provisions

Every operator adapting the planting density of a parcel under the particular planting provisions must lodge a declaration with the defence and management body at the latest within forty-eight hours following the end of the works. For each parcel concerned, the declaration specifies in particular:

- the cadastral references and the commune;

- the area.

3° – Declaration of parcel development

Before any development or any works liable to modify the morphology, the subsoil or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works, the operator sends a declaration to the ODG at least six weeks before the planned start date of the works.

The ODG transmits a copy of this declaration to the INAO services without delay.

4° – Claim declaration

The claim declaration is sent to the defence and management body before 30 April of the year following that of the harvest.

It indicates:

– the designation claimed;

– the volume of wine;

– the EVV or SIRET number;

– the name and address of the applicant;

– the place of storage of the wine.

It is accompanied by a copy of the harvest declaration and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for buyers of grapes and musts.

5° – Declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to dispatch outside the national territory a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin declares it to the approved control body at least ten working days before the dispatch.

6° – Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin declares it to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a maximum period of one month after this downgrading.

II. – Keeping of registers

1° – Weighing register

Pressing centres keep a weighing register separate from the press register. This register indicates for each weighing:

– the date and time of the weighing;

– the weight recorded;

– any particular claims (indication of a lieu-dit name…).

For centres pressing on behalf of third parties, the weighing register also specifies the name of the person delivering the grapes. A weighing ticket containing all these indications is issued to that person.

2° – Press register

Keeping a press register is compulsory. It is filled in as the pressing operations proceed. This register specifies, for each press load (marc):

– the date and time of the start of each operation;

– the weight of grapes used;

– the origin of the grapes, in the case of particular claims (indication of a lieu-dit name…);

– the name of the person who delivered the grapes;

– the quantity of wine obtained;

– the potential alcoholic strength by volume;

– the volumes of rebêches.

The quantity of wine obtained is only specified at the end of pressing.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A. – STRUCTURAL RULES	
A1. Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	Documentary (up-to-date CVI record) and in the field
A2. Claimable production potential (grape varieties, planting density and trellising, entry of the vines into production)	Documentary and field visits
A3. Development of a parcel	Documentary and field visit
A4. Processing facilities	
Reception and pressing, pressing site	On-site visit
B. – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1. Management of the vineyard	
Pruning	Verification of the pruning method adopted, of the number of free eyes per square metre (by counting) and of the completion of pruning work within the prescribed period
Average maximum load per parcel	Counting of bunches and estimation of the load
Cultivation condition of the vine and other cultivation practices	Check at the parcel
B2. Harvest and ripeness of the grapes	
Monitoring of the harvest date	Verification of derogations, field checks
B3. Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage	
Pressing	Documentary and on-site visit (verification of compliance with the pressing rules)
B4. Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Authorised yield	Documentary (check of the declarations)
Claim declaration	Documentary and on-site visit, check of the release of products into circulation
C. – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Wines before packaging	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all lots
Non-packaged wines intended for dispatch outside the national territory	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all lots

II. – References concerning the control structure

Institut National de l'Origine et de la Qualité (INAO)

TSA 30003, 93555 MONTREUIL Cedex

Tel.: (33) (0)1.73.30.38.00 – Email: contact@inao.gouv.fr

Compliance with the present specification is checked on the basis of an approved control plan, by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence that has received delegation from the INAO.